Use ChatGPT to Start Dad's Medicaid Application-Ready File

Four prompts to list the records you know about, note where each one is kept, write down the big transactions while people remember them, and prepare the questions to ask while there is time.

Where you are

Dad is managing fine and nobody is applying for anything. You've heard that a Medicaid application can ask for a long history of records, and you realize you couldn't say where half of his paperwork is.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names, account numbers, and case numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, determine eligibility, or give legal or financial advice. Bring those questions to your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney.

What you'll have at the end

You have a dated list of the records you know about, where each one is kept, what you haven't located, and the questions to raise with a professional while nothing is pressing.

A one-page records inventory: Records We Know About, Where Each Is Kept, What We Haven't Located, and Questions to Ask While There's Time.

Before you start

- A rough list of Dad's accounts, income, insurance, and property. From memory is fine; leave out account numbers.
- An idea of where his papers are kept: a drawer, a file box, online accounts.
- The name of whoever in the family would handle an application if one were ever needed. Two of the three is plenty.

PROMPT 1

List the records you know about

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most families have never written down what records exist. A list made in a quiet week is the start of an application-ready file.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A rough list of your father's accounts, income, insurance, and property, in your own words. No account numbers.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm organizing my father's records ahead of time. Nobody is applying for Medicaid now. Here is what I know about his accounts, income, insurance, and property, with no account numbers:

> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Using only what I've written, sort it under these headings: IDENTITY AND RESIDENCY, SOCIAL SECURITY AND INCOME, BANK ACCOUNTS, INVESTMENTS, RETIREMENT ACCOUNTS, INSURANCE, PROPERTY, TRUSTS AND ANNUITIES, and CARE AND MEDICAL. Where I said nothing under a heading, write "not noted" so I can see the blank. Do not add records I didn't mention, and do not tell me what Medicaid requires in my state.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A dated list of what you know about, with the blanks showing.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today's date at the top and ask one other family member what you left out.

PROMPT 2

Note where each record is kept and who can get to it

WHY THIS MATTERS

A record nobody can find is not much use. Knowing where things are, and who can reach them, is most of what "organized" means.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The list from the first prompt, and what you know about where papers and online accounts are kept.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my list of my father's records:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULT OF PROMPT 1]
>
> And here is what I know about where things are kept:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a table with four columns: RECORD, WHERE IT IS KEPT (paper, online, or with someone else), WHO CAN GET TO IT, and HOW SURE I AM (confirmed, assumed, or don't know). Do not suggest moving anything, changing ownership, or adding anyone to an account. Just show me what I know and what I'm assuming.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The rows marked “assumed” or “don’t know.” Those are the conversations to have with Dad.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask Dad about the “don’t know” rows when it is a good time for him.

PROMPT 3

Write down the big transactions while people remember them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sales, gifts, and large deposits or withdrawals are easy to explain this year and hard to explain years later. A dated note now saves reconstructing it from memory.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on the larger financial events you can remember from recent years, and whatever paperwork you know exists.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the larger financial events I can remember in my father’s recent years, such as property sold, large deposits or withdrawals, gifts to family, and accounts opened or closed:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a dated list with three columns: WHAT HAPPENED, ROUGHLY WHEN, and WHAT PAPERWORK EXISTS (or “none found yet”). Do not comment on whether any of this matters for Medicaid, and do not suggest making, changing, or undoing any gift or transfer. Those are questions for a professional. Just help me record what happened while people still remember it.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A plain record of events and paperwork, with no judgments attached.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put a copy of any paperwork you find with the list.

PROMPT 4

Turn the gaps into questions to ask while there's time

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some gaps you can close by looking in a drawer. Others, like how far back records need to go or what would indicate it is time to apply, belong to a professional. Sorting them is the point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts, plus the questions on your mind.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've put together about my father's records:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> And here are the questions I still have:
>
> [PASTE YOUR QUESTIONS]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: RECORDS WE KNOW ABOUT, WHERE EACH IS KEPT, WHAT WE HAVEN'T LOCATED, and QUESTIONS TO ASK WHILE THERE'S TIME. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or not sure. Do not answer questions about eligibility, how far back records need to go, gifts or transfers, or when to apply. List them so I can ask.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could update once a year and hand to a professional when the time comes.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Take the inventory one step further

You've listed the records you know about and the ones you haven't found. The planning interview is the next step: it produces a free planning report you can go over with your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›